

Mind reading

According to scientists at Intel labs, it would be able to identify different words you are thinking about and not just physical actions

ASUS N-Series

The latest series by ASUS feature a Core i5 CPU, NVIDIA GeForce GT325/415M graphics and Blu-ray **Tomorrow's tech**

other gadget that we commonly use, such as laptops and tablets. The limitations to the widespread introduction of wearable computers were notably insufficient battery life and processor power. Nevertheless, since the past ten years, decent number of successful implementations have been made.



The IBM WatchPad used Linux as its operating system

History of wearable computers

The history of wearable computers takes us way back to the 1500s. The pocket-watch invented back then can be noted as the first wearable computer. The concept of modern day wearable computers emerged in the 1960s. The system created was a cigarette packet-sized analogue computer that could predict

Russian roulette (a casino game) wheels.

Rapid development in this area picked up in the mid-90s. A workshop titled 'Wearable Computers within 2005' was conducted in collaboration with the US Defence Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA). They defined wearable computing as "data gathering and disseminating devices which enable the user to operate more efficiently". These devices are carried or worn by the user during normal execution.

Since then, there have been many research projects taken up and many wearable computers created. Several wearable computers have been developed through out the years. Some of them are as follows:

In 2001, IBM developed and publicly displayed two prototypes for a wristwatch computer running Linux. It sported a VGA screen. The WatchPad capable of handling text, photos and animation. It was considered to be

very useful for office purposes. Ease in maintenance of appointment details was a feature it promised. Steve Mann (a scientist from MIT) worked a lot in this field. In the 1980s, he designed and built a backpack-mounted 6502-based computer to control flash bulbs, cameras and other photographic systems. He developed this system, made it more compact and easy to use.

Concept behind wearable computers

There are two operational modes in this interaction between a human and computer:

Constancy: The device runs continuously, and is always ready to interact with the user. Unlike a laptop or a PC, you need not start up to use it. The signal flow diagram explains it better.

Augmentation: Unlike, traditional computing, wearable computing assumes that computing is not the primary task.

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*Source: virusbtl.com, April 2010

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